

5, People Perpetually Forget the Mutating Era, Committing the Blunder of Rigid Criteria Application due to Literal Misinterpretation

Another issue that I find particularly vexing is the playing of semantic games, regardless of whether the meanings of certain vocabulary are conflated intentionally or inadvertently. I maintain that far too many people, when observing history, completely forget the permutations of the era itself. The identical terminology in disparate historical epochs might signify astronomically divergent concepts; such misunderstandings are ubiquitous both domestically and internationally.

Take the Chinese **dynastic cycle** (王朝周期律)—which I have mentioned an untold number of times—as an example. I can assert with absolute certainty that even in China today, the proportion of individuals who can discern that the causes underlying the annihilation of the Han Dynasty (汉朝) and the annihilation of the Ming Dynasty (明朝) are diametrically distinct is less than one in ten thousand. Just because several regimes all collapsed after existing for two or three centuries fundamentally does not signify that the causes of their national demise were identical!

The duration of a **classical society's** (古典社会) existence inherently possesses its limits. Because imperial disintegration triggered by **feudalization** (封建化) and the collapse of social production under the **restoration-bureaucratic system** (复辟官僚制) are patently two entirely distinct phenomena. Perhaps people might argue that **The Han System** (汉制), acting as a **classical bureaucratic system** (古典官僚体制), was ultimately still excessively predatory, and that the uprisings and warlord conflagrations during the terminal Eastern Han (东汉末年) resulted in a phenomenally conspicuous annihilation of population and social production. Yet regardless of the circumstances, the annihilation of classical China constituted a normative consequence of the **feudalization** process; it is exceedingly difficult to argue that it possessed any correlation whatsoever with the **dynastic cycle** characteristically endemic to the **restoration-bureaucratic period** (复辟官僚时期).

Religions and ideological doctrines (*such as broadly encompassing doctrines like Confucianism*) are even more egregious disaster zones regarding rigid criteria application without regarding evolving circumstances (刻舟求剑). Although seasoned scholars are capable of executing differentiations, I sense that people—scholars included—still inherently lack a subconscious reflex to chronologically compartmentalize concepts concerning these ideological dimensions. For instance, despite uniformly operating under the umbrella of Confucianism (儒家学说), the Confucianism of the Han Dynasty and the Confucianism of the Ming and Qing periods exhibit colossal disparities.

Similarly, regarding Buddhism, at the precise same geographic locale, it could constitute a **classical religion** (古典宗教) during an earlier epoch, yet mutate into a **feudal religion** (封建宗教) during a later epoch. Concurrently, at the exact same chronological moment, Buddhism in one region might be a **classical religion**, while Buddhism in another region might be a **feudal religion**. Although I perpetually concede that my comprehension of religion is constrained—after all, the status of various religions domestically remains exceptionally delicate, and religious issues are, *de facto*, highly sensitive—I nevertheless still maintain that people perhaps overemphasize disparities in **religious doctrine** (宗教教义), frequently misinterpreting philosophical divergences as the primary catalysts for sectarian schisms. Based on my rudimentary observation, this assumption is genuinely profoundly questionable.

Undeniably, divergences concerning philosophical issues will precipitate the splintering of academic schools. However, religion is ultimately not an academic coterie composed exclusively of a minuscule minority of intellectuals within a society; it possesses multitudinous adherents and labyrinthine organizational structures across a phenomenally vast geographic expanse, maintains intimate relations with rulers, and plays a pivotal role in social life. Therefore, the genesis, schism, and extinction of a mainstream religion are overwhelmingly likely to be the direct consequence of mutations in **social being** (社会存在); mutations in **religious law** (宗教教法) inherently reflect the religion's adaptation to its environment. While doctrinal divergences might indeed concurrently reflect certain societal mutations, occasionally, they might merely serve as a convenient pretext for a definitive rupture. Regarding instances where **religious doctrines** mutated in tandem with the fluctuation of **social being**, we have already discovered copious examples when discussing Islam and Buddhism.

I contend that the Great Schism between Catholicism (天主教) and Orthodoxy (东正教) constitutes a quintessential paradigm of religious schism precipitated by disparities in the social historical process. Admittedly, people might already be capable of discerning the distinct social realities lurking behind doctrinal differences from the *Filioque* (和子句) controversy. Orthodoxy rigidly adheres to the description in the Nicene Creed (《尼西亚信经》) that "the Holy Spirit proceeds from the Father," whereas the Latin Church embraced the "and the Son" (*Filioque*) perspective, asserting that "the Holy Spirit proceeds from the Father and the Son."

People can indeed observe the ideological disparities lurking behind this doctrinal divergence: the Catholic Church maintains that the Church possesses the authority to supplement and refine the Creed in accordance with the permutations of the era and the deepening of comprehension. Conversely, the Orthodox Church maintains that local churches are forbidden from tampering with the Creed established by the Universal Church; they harbor an even profounder revulsion toward the prospect that, by appending the Son, the Father's status as the singular, absolute fountainhead of divinity would be challenged. They adamantly insist that the Holy Spirit can only proceed from the Father, and that the Son is merely the instrument through which the Father created all things, categorically not the source of the Holy Spirit.

As a resident of China, I indeed do not comprehend Christianity; however, the social and familial environment in which I reside endows me with my own unique perception regarding this *Filioque* clause. I imagine the majority of people who have lived in mainland China like myself would harbor this exact sensation: the Byzantine Orthodox Church's vehement repudiation of the *Filioque* clause precisely reflects the conceptual morphology of a despotic **bureaucratic state** (专制官僚国家). It is identically synonymous with the Chinese rulers emphasizing "Ruler-Subject, Father-Son" (君臣父子): **apart from the supreme, paramount emperor, there is zero secondary source of power under heaven, and the ritualistic hierarchy (礼制) is eternal and inalterable.**

However, would the Eastern and Western Churches genuinely not have schismed even without this *Filioque* (和子句) clause? Naturally, it is impossible.

The essence of the East-West Schism lay in the fact that the entire Christian world had already fractured into two halves: the West was already populated by a multitude of **feudal states** (封建国家), whereas a colossal **late-classical state** (晚期古典国家) still persisted in the East. Since these two societies had parted ways, it was an inevitable reality for Christianity to fracture into Eastern and

Western halves; both sides were compelled to adapt to their respective societies, thereby ultimately generating irreconcilable disparities in **religious law** (宗教教法) and **religious doctrine** (宗教教义).

I can assert with absolute certainty that even if the so-called *Filioque* clause had never existed in history, the Eastern and Western Churches would definitively have schismed due to other reasons; it would merely have been an issue of generating a divergence in some other unknown location within the Creed. Even the chronological timing of the East-West Schism would not have exhibited any disparity; it would still have occurred in the 11th century AD.

The reason is exceedingly simple: 11th-century Western Europe had already entered the High Middle Ages (中世纪盛期), and its **feudal society** (封建社会) had matured. Conversely, Byzantium, following the rule of the Macedonian dynasty (马其顿王朝), once again manifested the illusion of a resurgence; the emperors self-righteously adopted numerous measures to "de-feudalize" (去封建化).

Under this push and pull, it would genuinely have been a monstrous absurdity if the contradictions between the Eastern and Western Churches—accumulated over several centuries due to their disparate historical processes—did not culminate in a total eruption.

For a universal religion birthed during the pre-feudalization period (前封建化时期), schisming into a **classical religion** (古典宗教) branch and a **feudal religion** (封建宗教) branch due to the disparate historical processes across the globe is phenomenally normal. The pairing of Orthodoxy and Catholicism possesses fundamentally no essential distinction from the pairing of Mahayana Buddhism (大乘佛教) and Theravada Buddhism (上座部佛教).

However, regarding reality, as a Chinese individual, the phenomenon I find most bizarre is that the disparities in the concepts of "Marxism" (马克思主义) and "Communism" (共产主义) between the East and the West could actually be neglected to such an astronomical degree. I only discovered quite late that the overwhelming majority of people in Europe, Japan, and identically the United States actually genuinely believe that the Marxism and Communism spoken of by the Soviet Union and China constitute the exact same concept as those spoken of by Western European nations! This is frankly so foolish it borders on naïve adorability.

Setting Russia aside, the social process of China exhibits a divergence accumulated over at least a dozen centuries compared to Western Europe. Because the **restoration-bureaucratic society** (复辟官僚社会) exists entirely outside the **historical sequence** (历史序列), exactly how colossal the specific divergence is remains fundamentally impossible even to estimate. Even if the vocabulary is identical, pronounced identically, and written identically, could they possibly be the exact same thing?

In Europe, Marxism is an academic doctrine, and Communism is an imagined ideal society; yet in nations where the Bolsheviks (布尔什维克) genuinely seized power, analogous concepts served exclusively one singular objective: seeking legitimacy for bureaucratic rule (为官僚统治寻求合法性).

Europe and the United States battled the Soviet Union in the ideological realm for over a generation; if they still remain clueless regarding this, it is genuinely baffling.

5, 人们总是忘记时代在变化, 由于望文生义而犯下刻舟求剑般的错误

另一个在我看来尤其困扰人的问题是文字游戏, 无论一些词语的含义是有意还是无意被混淆的。我认为太多人在看待历史的过程中忘记了时代本身的变化, 同样一个词语在不同的历史使其指向的概念可能差别极大, 无论是国内外这样的误解屡见不鲜。就拿我说过不知道多少次的中国王朝周期律为例子,

我可以很肯定地讲，即使在今天中国能分清汉朝灭亡和明朝灭亡的原因截然不同的人也不到万分之一。几个政权都存在了两三百年灭亡了，这不代表令其亡国的原因是一样的啊！古典社会存在的时间有其限度。因为封建化导致的帝国解体和复辟官僚制下社会生产的崩溃显然就是两回事。或许人们会说汉制作作为一种古典官僚体制掠夺性还是太强了，东汉末年的起义和军阀混战对于人口和社会生产的消灭太过显著。但是无论如何古典中国的灭亡都是封建化进程的一般结果，跟复辟官僚时期的王朝周期律是很难说有关系的。

宗教和思想学说（像儒学这样广泛的思想学说）更是刻舟求剑的重灾区，虽然说有经验的学者能够进行区分，但是包括学者在内，我感到人们还是缺乏对于这些意识形态方面的概念缺乏分段的潜意识。就好比同样都是儒家学说，汉代的儒学跟明清时期的儒学差异极大。同样都是佛教，在同一个地点早一些时属于古典宗教，晚一些时就变成了封建宗教；在同一个时间，一个地方的佛教是古典宗教，另一个地方的佛教可能是封建宗教。虽然说我向来承认自己对于宗教了解有限，毕竟在国内各种宗教的地位还是非常微妙的，宗教问题事实上很敏感。不过我依然认为人们可能太注重教义上的区别了，并且把一些哲学问题的分歧视为教派分裂的主要原因。根据我浅显的观察，这一点真的很值得怀疑。

毫无疑问哲学问题的分歧会使得学派分裂，然而宗教毕竟不是只由一个社会中极少数知识分子所构成的学术团体，它在一个相当广大的地域内拥有众多的信众和复杂的组织机构，与统治者保持着密切的关系并且在社会生活中扮演重要角色。因此越是主流的宗教的诞生、分裂和消亡就越有可能是社会存在发生变化的结果，教法上的变化反映了宗教对于环境的适应。而教义上的分歧虽然也可能反映社会的某些变化，不过在有的时候可能仅仅是一个决裂的借口。有关宗教教义随着社会存在的变动而产生变化这样的例子，我们已经在论及伊斯兰教和佛教时找到不少了。

我认为天主教和东正教的分裂就是因为社会历史进程差异而造成宗教分裂的经典例子。诚然人们从“和子句”分歧上或许已经能够看出教义区别背后的不同社会现实。东正教坚持《尼西亚信经》的描述“圣灵是从父而出的”，而拉丁教会接受了“和子”的观点，认为“圣灵是从父和子而出的”。人们的确可以看到教义分歧背后的意识差别，天主教会认为教会有权根据时代的变化和理解的深入，对信经进行补充和完善。而东正教会则认为地方教会不能篡改普世教会制定的信经，更厌恶加上圣子之后圣父作为神性唯一源头的地位受到挑战。他们坚持圣灵只能从圣父而出，圣子是圣父借以创造万物的工具，并非圣灵的来源。作为一个中国的居民我的确不懂基督教，但是我所生活的社会环境和家庭环境又让我对于这个“和字句”有自己的认识。我想像我这样大部分在中国大陆生活的人都会有这种感觉：拜占庭的东正教如此否定“和子句”正是反映了专制官僚国家社会形态的观念，与中国统治者强调“君臣父子”的是一样的，除了至高无上的皇帝以外，天下没有第二个权力来源，礼制是永恒不可更改的。

然而即使没有这个“和子句”东西教会就不分裂了吗？当然不可能。东西教会分裂的本质在于整个基督教世界已经分成了两部分，西方已经是封建国家林立，而东方却仍然存在一个庞大的晚期古典国家。既然这两个社会分道扬镳了，那么在基督教分成东西两个部分就是必然的事情，两方都必须适应各自的社会，进而最终在教法和教义上产生不可弥合的差别。我可以很肯定地讲，所谓“和子句”即使从来没有在历史上存在过，东西教会一定会因为其他原因产生分裂，无非是信经的不知道哪个位置又产生了区别的问题。甚至东西教会分裂的时间都不会有什么差异，也会是在公元11世纪。原因很简单，公元11世纪的西欧已经进入中世纪盛期，封建社会已经成熟起来。而拜占庭经过马其顿王朝的统治又显现出中兴的假象，皇帝们自以为是地采取了不少去“封建化”的措施。就这么一来一往，东方教会和西方教会因为历史进程不同积累了几个世纪的矛盾不发生总爆发那真是咄咄怪事。对于在前封建化时期就诞生的世界性宗教而言，因为世界各地历史进程的不同分裂为古典宗教分支和封建宗教分支再正常不过了，东正教和天主教这一对与大乘佛教和上座部佛教这一对其实没有本质区别。

不过就现实而言，作为中国人我感到最离奇的事情还是“马克思主义”和“共产主义”这两个概念在东西方之间的差异竟然会被忽视到如此程度。我到很晚的时候才发现包括美国在内的欧洲和日本，绝大多数人竟然真的认为苏联和中国所说的马克思主义和共产主义跟西欧国家所说的是一个概念！这未免也太傻到可爱了。抛开俄国不谈，中国的社会进程跟西欧存在少说十几个世纪积累的差异。因为复辟官僚社会不在历史序列之内，具体差异多大甚至根本没法估计。哪怕词是一个词，念起来一样写起来也一样，这能是一回事吗？马克思主义在欧洲是一种学说，共产主义在欧洲是一种想象的理想社会，但是在布尔什维克真正掌权的国家，类似的概念只有一个目的，那就是为官僚统治寻求合法性。欧美在意识形态领域和苏联斗了超过一代人的时间，如果他们对此仍然不清楚那这实在是让人费解。